

4. Dynamics of a particle moving in a straight line or plane

What students need to learn:

The concept of a force. Newton's laws of motion.

Simple problems involving constant acceleration in scalar form or as a vector of the form $a\mathbf{i} + b\mathbf{j}$.

Simple applications including the motion of two connected particles.

Problems may include

- (i) the motion of two connected particles moving in a straight line or under gravity when the forces on each particle are constant; problems involving smooth fixed pulleys and/or pegs may be set;
- (ii) motion under a force which changes from one fixed value to another, e.g. a particle hitting the ground;
- (iii) motion directly up or down a smooth or rough inclined plane.

Momentum and impulse. The impulse-momentum principle. The principle of conservation of momentum applied to two particles colliding directly.

Knowledge of Newton's law of restitution is not required. Problems will be confined to those of a one-dimensional nature.

Coefficient of friction.

An understanding of $F = \mu R$ when a particle is moving.
